Cinema seat reservation app

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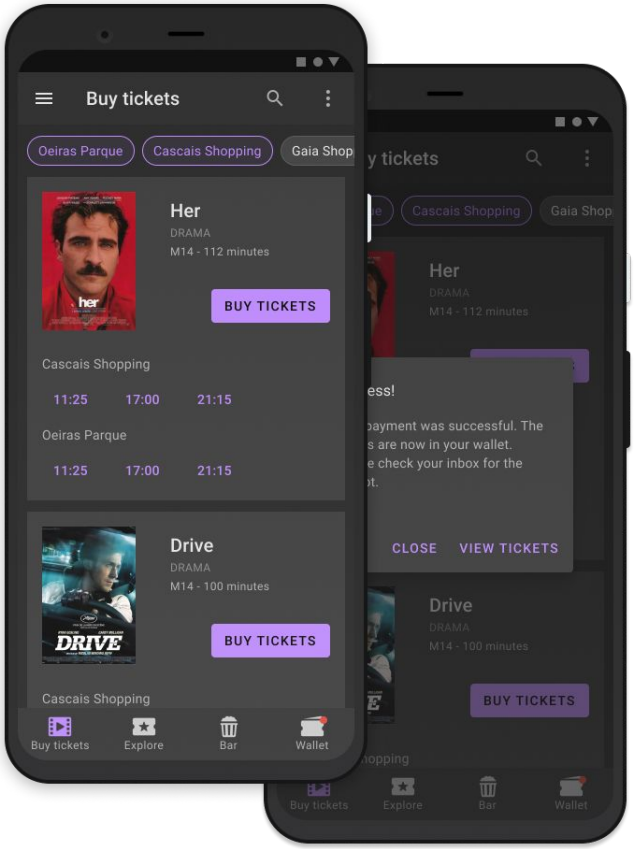
Project overview

The product:

Cinematic is a seat reservation app for a cinema. The main goal of the app is to improve the cinema experience by letting users manage bookings through their phones and minimise time spent queuing.

Project duration:

September 2021 - November 2021



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Project overview

The problem:

Busy workers and students have to deal with crowds and queuing at the cinema.

The goal:

Create a seat reservation experience that is simple and intuitive to use and that helps users save time and relax at the cinema.

Project overview

My role:

UX designer and researcher designing an app for cinematic from conception to delivery.

Responsibilities:

Conducting interviews, paper and digital wireframing, low and high-fidelity prototyping, conducting usability studies, accounting for accessibility, and iterating on designs.

Understanding the user

- User research
- Personas
- Problem statements
- User journey maps

User research: summary

I conducted interviews and created empathy maps to understand the users I'm designing for and their needs. A primary user group identified through research was young adults that experienced frustrations with current online booking experiences.

This user group revealed that users were looking for a simpler and more effective way to buy tickets, and that they needed to see a clear benefit from using the mobile app in order to make that change.

User research: pain points

1

Lack of Feedback

The current online booking experience often lacks feedback and is confusing to users.

2

Crowded Environment

Users can’t predict how busy the cinema will be and if they will have to spend a lot of time queuing.

3

Payment Options

Users experience a lack of payment options.

4

Big Groups

Big groups don’t have a good way to coordinate a group ticket online.

Persona: **Linda**

Problem statement:

Linda is a busy professional who needs a way to check the availability of cinemas because hates crowded spaces.

Linda

Age: 50
Education: Phd Mathematics
Hometown: Lyon, France
Family: Partner
Occupation: Professor

"When I was younger it wasn't even allowed to eat at the cinema"

Goals

- Spontaneously watch a movie at the cinema
- Relax on the weekend with her partner
- See a movie that got good reviews

Frustrations

- Showing up at the cinema and not having tickets
- Having to wait in line
- Getting distracted by people eating popcorn and being on their phones

Linda is a university professor who enjoys going to the cinema with her partner as a way of relaxing on the weekends. Although she prefers to be spontaneous, sometimes she gets frustrated when there are too many people at the cinema and she has to wait in line. She prefers to buy tickets online for popular films but tries to avoid this because she finds this experience cumbersome.

Persona: **Tom**

Problem statement:

Tom is a high school student who needs a better way to coordinate group tickets with friends because it's hard seat together in popular films.

Tom

Age: 16
Education: Highschool
Hometown: Lisbon, Portugal
Family: Parents and sister
Occupation: Student

"I want to have a good time with my friends and not have to spend too much time planning"

Goals

- Get movie tickets on short notice
- Decide with friends what movie to watch and where to seat
- Buy seats next to friends

Frustrations

- I hate when I have to start over online because something went wrong
- Often I don't even understand what went wrong
- I don't have a credit card so I can't buy tickets online without my parents

Tom is a highschool student who often enjoys watching movies at the cinema with his friends. Although he and his friends are very comfortable with technology and would prefer to buy tickets on their phones, they often end up buying them at the cinema because it's harder to coordinate with everyone online, they don't have credit cards and they are frustrated by the existing online experience.

User journey map

Pain points

- Waiting in line
- Too much hassle to book online
- Lack of feedback

Actionables

- Intuitive flow
- Save time
- Group ticket feature

Persona: Tom

Goal: Watch a movie at the theatre with a group of friends

ACTION	Decide what movie to watch	Get to the cinema	Find his friends	Buy a ticket	Watch the movie
TASK LIST	Tasks A. Propose going to the cinema on the group chat B. Debate possible options C. Decide	Tasks A. Open maps to check the route B. Walk to the bus station C. Take the bus	Tasks A. Message the group B. Walk around C. Ask for a friend's location	Tasks A. Go to the ticket counter B. Ask for tickets for the movie C. Buy seats in different spots because the movie is almost full	Tasks A. Find the room where the movie is screening B. Watch the movie C. Talk about the movie with friends when it finishes
FEELING ADJECTIVE	User emotions - Excited about going to the cinema - Indecisive about what to watch	User emotions - Concerned about being late	User emotions - Confused about where his friends are	User emotions - Frustrated about not being able to seat next to his friends	User emotions - Energised to discuss the movie
IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES	Integrated way do see movie reviews and scores and share them on popular messaging apps Voting feature to help decide on a movie		Popular meet up points close to the movie theaters	Better mobile experience Way to buy group tickets More payment options	Way to rate the movies and share your experience

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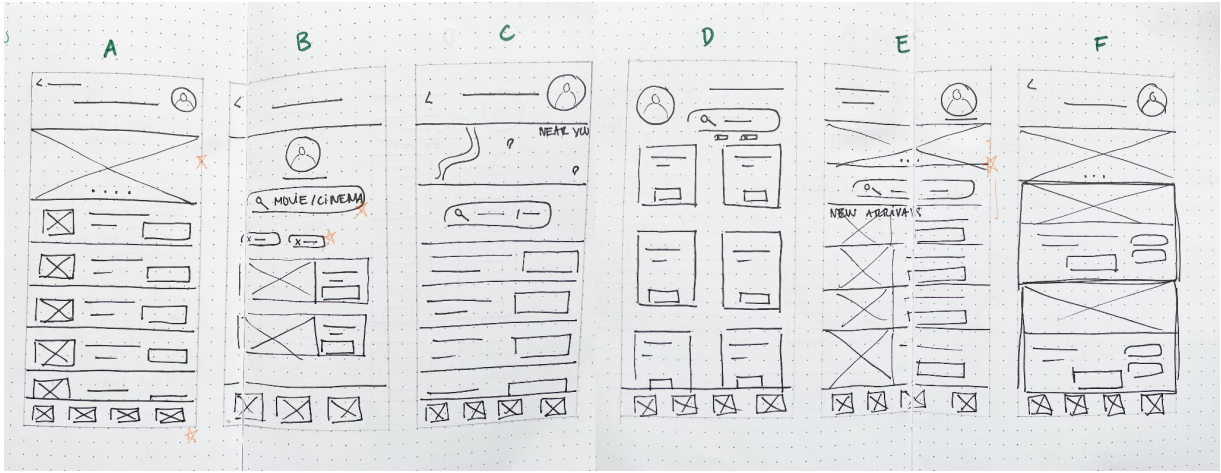
Starting the design

- Paper wireframes
- Digital wireframes
- Low-fidelity prototype
- Usability studies

Paper wireframes

I explored iterations of each screen of the app on paper to ensured that the final elements on the digital wireframes would truly address user pain points. For the home screen, I prioritized a **quick and easy way** for users to find films and other relevant information.

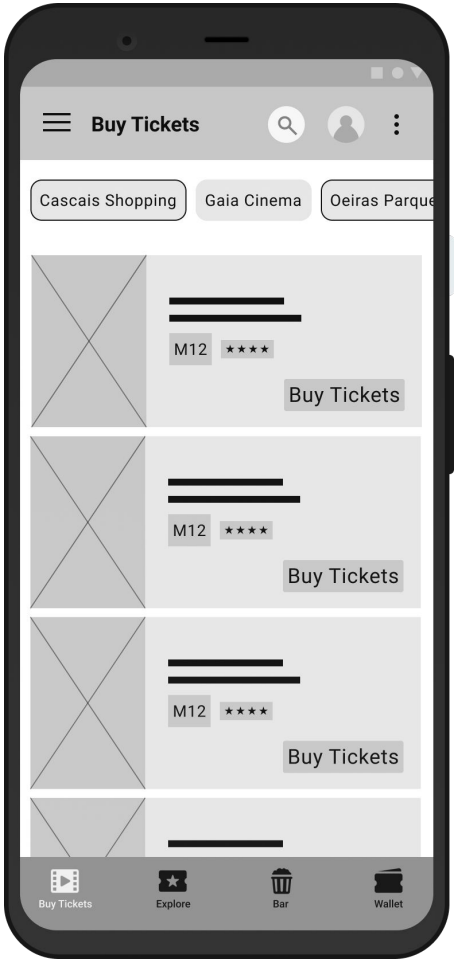


Stars were used to mark the elements of each sketch that would be used in the initial digital wireframes.

Digital wireframes

As the ideation phase continued, I made sure to use feedback and findings from the user research to inform my designs.

The filters let users select their preferred cinema locations



The main user flow to buy tickets is clearly indicated by this button

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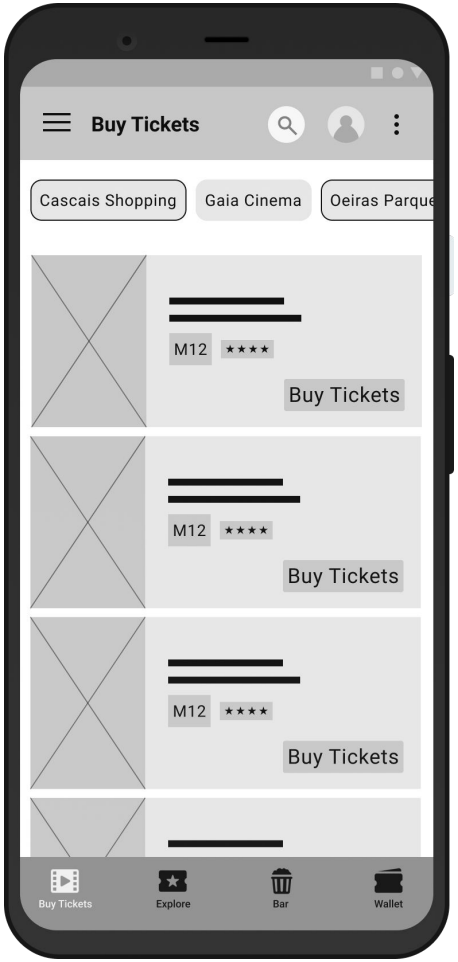
Digital wireframes

Bottom tabs have become a very popular mode of navigation in mobile apps. Accessibility considerations need to be made during the implementation process in order to make the navigation compatible with screen readers.

Accessibility needs to be considered during implementation in order to make the navigation screen reader friendly



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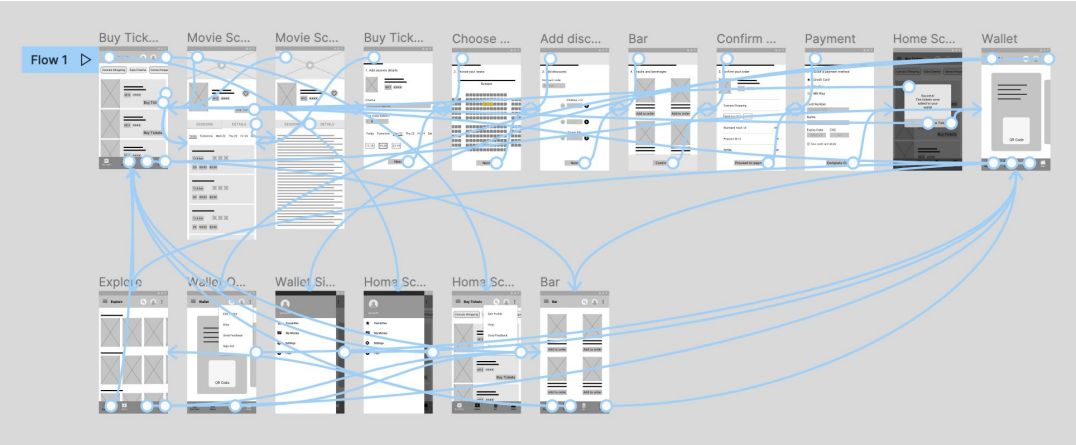
Low-fidelity prototype

I created a low-fidelity prototype with the complete set of digital wireframes. The primary user flow I wanted to test in a usability study was buying tickets for a film.



View the Cinematic [low-fidelity prototype]

Usability study: findings

I conducted two rounds of usability studies. Findings from the first study helped guide the designs from wireframes to mockups. The second study used a high-fidelity prototype and revealed what aspects of the mockups needed refining.

Round 1 findings

1. Users want to buy tickets quickly
2. Users found the group ticket feature unnecessary
3. Users want to see the available films at their preferred locations

Round 2 findings

1. Users want to see the price of discounted tickets
2. Users want to save payment details

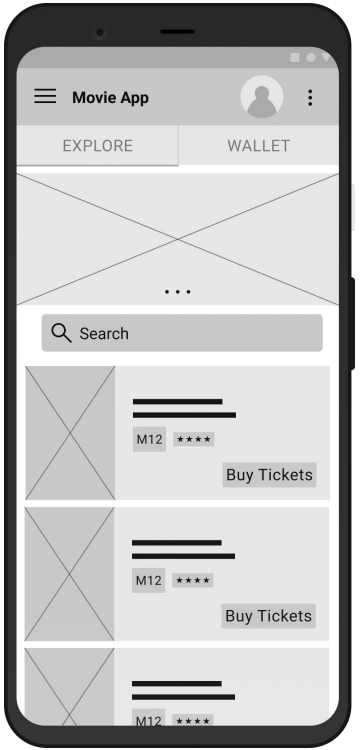
Refining the design

- Mockups
- High-fidelity prototype
- Accessibility

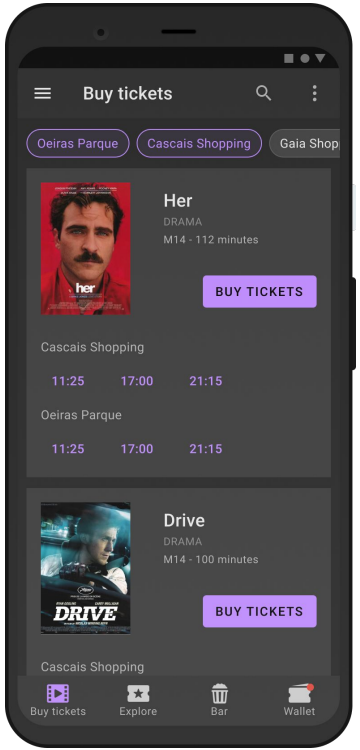
Mockups

Early designs only showed details about the film, like time and location, once the user started the flow to buy tickets. After the usability studies, I added the possibility to **filter by location** when the users first land on the screen as well as **session times** that update accordingly.

Before usability study



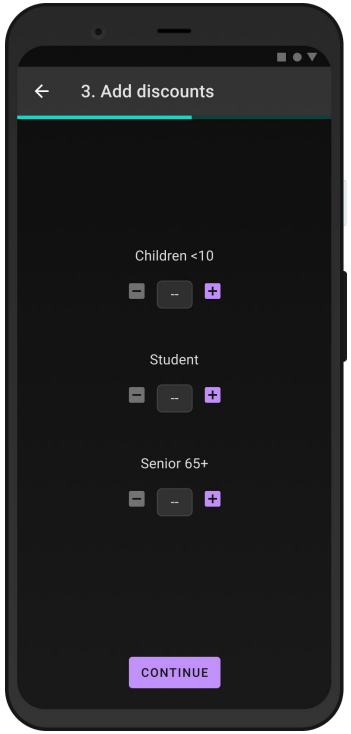
After usability study



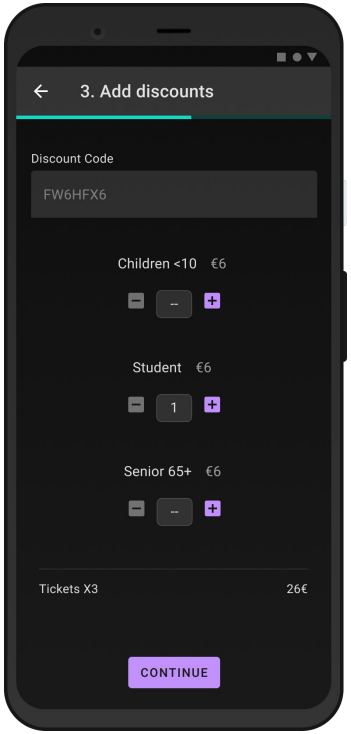
Mockups

The second usability study revealed frustration with the discounts screen. I felt **users needed more feedback** at this stage so I added the **price of the discounted tickets** and how they affect the final order.

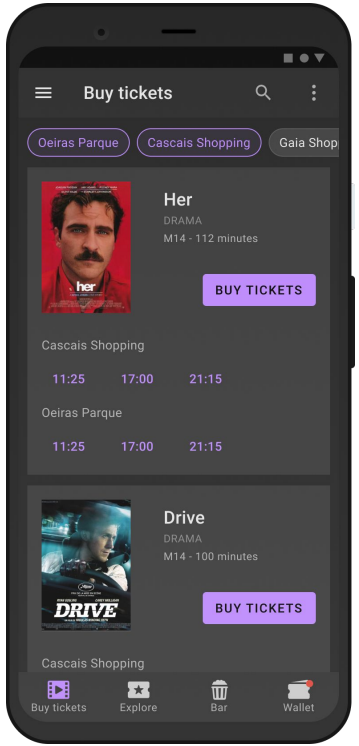
Before usability study

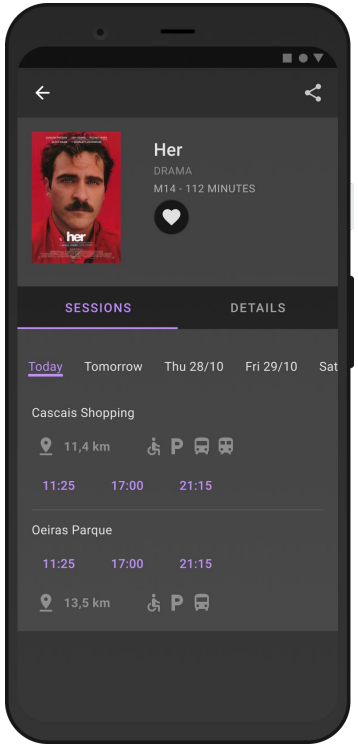


After usability study



Key mockups


Buy tickets
Oeiras Parque
Cascais Shopping
Gaia Shop
Her
DRAMA
M14 - 112 minutes
BUY TICKETS
Cascais Shopping
11:25
17:00
21:15
Oeiras Parque
11:25
17:00
21:15
Drive
DRAMA
M14 - 100 minutes
BUY TICKETS
Cascais Shopping
Buy tickets
Explore
Bar
Wallet


Her
DRAMA
M14 - 112 MINUTES
SESSIONS
DETAILS
Today
Tomorrow
Thu 28/10
Fri 29/10
Sat
Cascais Shopping
11,4 km
11:25
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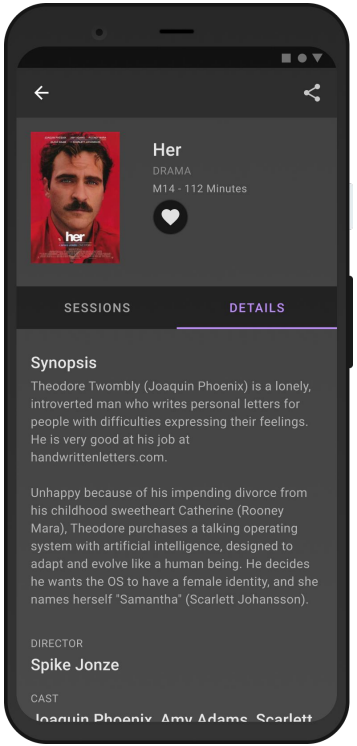
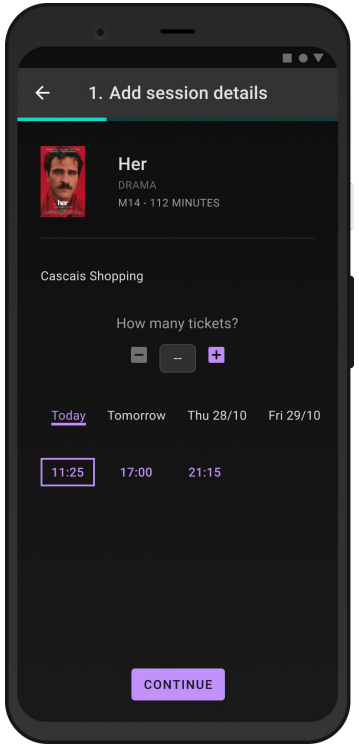
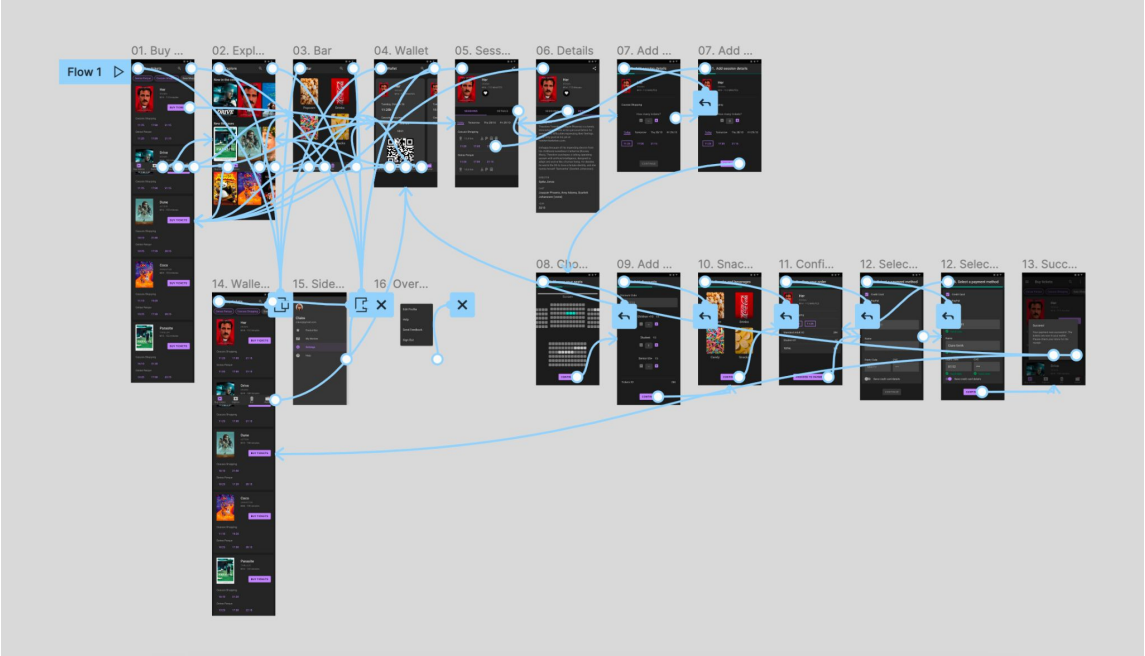
Oeiras Parque
11:25
17:00
21:15
13,5 km


Her
DRAMA
M14 - 112 Minutes
SESSIONS
DETAILS
Synopsis
Theodore Twombly (Joaquin Phoenix) is a lonely, introverted man who writes personal letters for people with difficulties expressing their feelings. He is very good at his job at handwrittenletters.com.
Unhappy because of his impending divorce from his childhood sweetheart Catherine (Rooney Mara), Theodore purchases a talking operating system with artificial intelligence, designed to adapt and evolve like a human being. He decides he wants the OS to have a female identity, and she names herself "Samantha" (Scarlett Johansson).
DIRECTOR
Spike Jonze
CAST


1. Add session details
Her
DRAMA
M14 - 112 MINUTES
Cascais Shopping
How many tickets?
--
Today
Tomorrow
Thu 28/10
Fri 29/10
11:25
17:00
21:15
CONTINUE

High-fidelity prototype

The final high-fidelity prototype achieved a cleaner user flow for buying the tickets. It also met user needs for more feedback along the way and an easier way to find film sessions based on location.



View the Cinematic [high-fidelity prototype]

Accessibility considerations

1

Added alt text to images for screen readers to support users with impaired vision.

2

Used icons to make navigation easier.

3

Provided information about wheelchair access at each location.

Going forward

- Takeaways
- Next steps

Takeaways

Impact:

Users feel like Cinematic is easy to use and meets their needs by providing proper feedback and saving them time..

One quote from peer feedback:

“The app made it super easy to buy tickets for a film and access everything directly from my phone. I loved that you could also add bar items directly to your order.”

What I learned:

While designing the Cinematic app, I learned how valuable user feedback is. Usability studies and peer feedback were crucial in bringing each iteration of the app’s designs closer to what users really needed.

Next steps

1

Validate whether the pain points users experienced have been effectively addressed with another round of usability studies.

2

Conduct more research to determine other user needs.

3

Investigate the possibility of iterating on the group ticket feature and test the viability of this feature with users.

Let’s connect!

Thank you for your time reviewing my work on the Cinematic app! If you’d like to see more or get in touch, my contact information is provided below.

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